

Chapter 74-4

"Dr. Zhao, are you really going to rent this apartment to me?" Liang Shi was a bit in disbelief.

"Lending it to you as a transition." Zhao Xuning said, "Move out once you've bought your own place."

"Why did you buy this apartment in the first place?" Liang Shi opened the window. It had just rained, and even the air carried a coolness, but the breeze felt very comfortable. "As an investment?"

Zhao Xuning was silent for a moment. "No."

"Then why did you buy it?" Liang Shi was surprised. "Could it be a marital home? But your family would definitely buy you a villa."

"No." Zhao Xuning denied again.

Afraid that Liang Shi would ask more questions, Zhao Xuning explained, "I lived here with my girlfriend when I was in university."

Liang Shi: ".....??"

No one could resist gossip!

Even someone as zen and steady as Liang Shi subconsciously lit up. "Was it the one I saw at the hospital last time?"

Zhao Xuning responded softly, "Mm."

"So you two were university classmates?" Liang Shi sighed with emotion. "How nice, a campus romance."

"You never dated?" Zhao Xuning asked back.

Liang Shi shook her head. "Would you believe me if I said I never went to university?"

Zhao Xuning was stunned for a moment, then said, "I already told you not to tell me about things from your side."

Liang Shi: "....."

That fear of getting into trouble came up again.

But seeing her like this, Liang Shi found it funny and deliberately teased her. "Then I'll tell you anyway."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

"I actually bought a place." Liang Shi said, "It was also a river-view apartment, but now it's all gone."

Zhao Xuning: ".....Serves you right."

"What kind of thing is that to say?" Liang Shi scoffed lightly. "Dr. Zhao, you really don't know the hardships of life."

"As if you do." Zhao Xuning called out sarcastically, "Third Young Miss Liang."

"Of course I do." Liang Shi said, "I started from nothing too, you know? Before I entered the entertainment industry, I had nothing—I rented a basement, then a semi-basement, then shared a place with others. Only after I made money from filming did I upgrade my living situation."

"Fishing for sympathy?" Zhao Xuning glanced at her sideways.

Liang Shi shook her head. "What's pitiful about that? I'm just chatting. Since I came here, you're the first person who can listen to me talk about these things."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

Although Zhao Xuning still felt that Liang Shi might be mentally disturbed, seeing her speak so confidently couldn't help but make her waver a little. But after a few seconds, Zhao Xuning would once again firmly believe that Liang Shi was indeed mentally disturbed.

"So what did you gain from entering the entertainment industry?" Zhao Xuning continued along with her words.

"Money and fans." Liang Shi said, "Oh right, I also won Best Actress."

Zhao Xuning's eyelid twitched, and she praised expressionlessly, "Impressive."

Liang Shi: "....."

She lost her desire to share and instead complained, "You're just humoring me."

Zhao Xuning nodded. "As long as you can tell."

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi asked Zhao Xuning very sincerely, "Dr. Zhao, with your annoying personality, how did you manage to find such an excellent girlfriend?"

Zhao Xuning: "....."

Zhao Xuning closed the window, her voice colder than the autumn wind outside. "She just liked that I was annoying."

"But you still broke up in the end." Liang Shi blurted out subconsciously, then quickly tried to make amends. "I didn't mean to insult you."

Zhao Xuning glanced at her sideways. "How is that any different from insulting someone?"

Liang Shi: "....."

In the end, Liang Shi decided not to exchange barbs with Zhao Xuning anymore, after all, the other party was about to become her landlord.

This apartment was currently the best choice for her, so she communicated with Zhao Xuning very "amicably."

An apartment that hadn't been lived in for too long appeared lifeless, but all the rooms were decorated in warm tones, which was extremely inconsistent with the current aloof flower Dr. Zhao.¹

Especially the master bedroom.

The wallpaper was a girlish pink, completely at odds with Dr. Zhao's image.

It was hard to imagine what Dr. Zhao was like when she was in a relationship.

Footnotes:

¹ "高嶺之花" (gāolǐng zhī huā) - Literally "flower on a high peak." This is a term used to describe someone who is beautiful and admirable but seems unapproachable or out of reach, like a flower growing on a tall mountain that one can only admire from afar but never pick.